

Nicholas Ashton Smith

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SUMMARY

Entry-level IT Support Specialist with hands-on experience in building, configuring, and maintaining IT systems. Experienced in troubleshooting hardware and software, supporting end-users, and implementing efficient IT solutions to improve system performance and reliability.

EXPERIENCE

IT Support Specialist | Freelance

June 2025 - Present

- Installed, configured, and troubleshooted hardware and software for individual clients.
- Provided step-by-step technical guidance to non-technical users, reducing repeat support requests.
- Built and upgraded custom PCs tailored to client needs, improving system performance and reliability.

Package Handler | UPS & FedEx

August 2024 – July 2025

- Coordinated with team members to resolve workflow bottlenecks, improving overall efficiency.
- Utilized scanning and logistics software to troubleshoot and document package handling issues.

Retail Sales Consultant | Prime Communications (AT&T)

July 2023 – August 2024

- Resolved Tier-1 technical issues at first contact, reducing escalations to advanced support.
- Acted as a liaison between customers and advanced support teams for complex cases.
- Educated users on devices and workflows, improving their experience and reducing repeat issues.

PROJECTS

Cloud & Virtualized IT Environment

- Built and managed a Proxmox virtual lab with Windows and Linux systems.
- Configured WireGuard VPN, VLANs, file sharing, and firewall rules for secure remote access.
- Implemented user access controls, automated backups, and system monitoring.

Custom PC & Home Lab Builds

- Built and upgraded multiple custom PCs tailored for performance, reliability, and specific workloads.
- Assembled a home lab environment including servers, storage, and networking devices for hands-on testing.
- Tested and optimized system performance, networking connectivity, and software deployment workflows.

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

CompTIA A+	In Progress
ISC2 CC (Certified in Cybersecurity)	November 2025 – November 2028
Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate Coursera	October 2025
HarvardX Computer Science for Cybersecurity Certificate edX	August 2025

SKILLS

Operating Systems: Windows 10/11/Server, Linux (Debian/Ubuntu), Android, iOS
Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VLANs, VPNs, Firewall Configuration, Wi-Fi Troubleshooting
System Administration: Active Directory, Office 365, Group Policy, RDP, File Shares, Backup Automation
Support Tools: TeamViewer, AnyDesk, Zoom, Remote Desktop, Basic Ticketing Systems
Scripting & Automation: Python, Bash
Soft Skills: Troubleshooting, Customer Support, Communication, Documentation, Multitasking, Adaptability